

Present Simple vs Present Continuous

Sorting Cards Activity

Instructions for the Teacher

Use this activity to help students practise distinguishing between the Present Simple (habits, routines) and Present Continuous (actions happening now).

1. Print and cut out the cards. Laminate them for durability.
2. Give each pair/small group a set of cards and a mat for each tense.
3. Use the extension tasks for optional writing or speaking practice.

Writing Extension Task

Each student writes two new Present Simple sentences and two Present Continuous sentences. Then, they swap with their partners and guess the tense for each sentence.

Speaking Extension Task

Play a mime game: One student acts out a Present Continuous sentence (e.g. "I am brushing my teeth.") and the others guess the sentence using the correct tense.

Instructions for Students

Work in pairs or small groups.

Read each card. Decide if the sentence is in the Present Simple or Present Continuous tense.

Put the cards on the matching mat.

Explain your choices to your partner.



**Present
Continuous**



**Present
Simple**





**My mom is
cooking dinner.**

twinkl.com



**She plays piano at
the weekend.**

twinkl.com



**She is wearing
a red dress today.**

twinkl.com



**My dad works in a
bank.**

twinkl.com



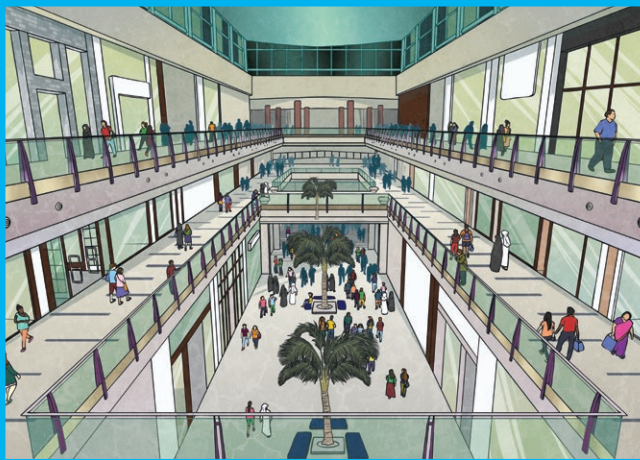
**I am not watching
TV now.**

twinkl.com



**The sun rises in
the east.**

twinkl.com



They are at the shopping centre.

twinkl.com



He reads a book before bed.

twinkl.com



We are studying English this week.

twinkl.com



I don't like bananas.

twinkl.com



Are they coming to the party?

twinkl.com



Do they live near the park?

twinkl.com

banana

apple

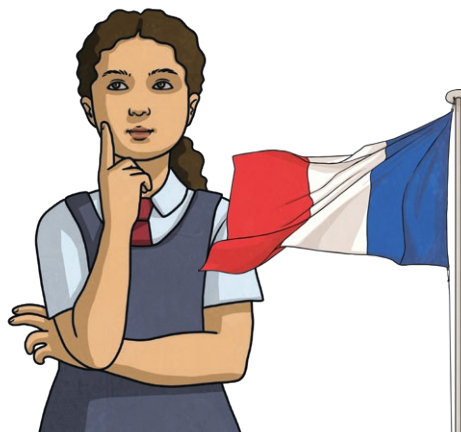
tomato

grapes

pear

**We are learning
new words.**

twinkl.com



**Does she speak
French?**

twinkl.com



**I am drinking
water.**

twinkl.com



**The dog sleeps in
the garden.**

twinkl.com



**He is eating lunch
right now.**

twinkl.com



**I clean my room
every weekend.**

twinkl.com



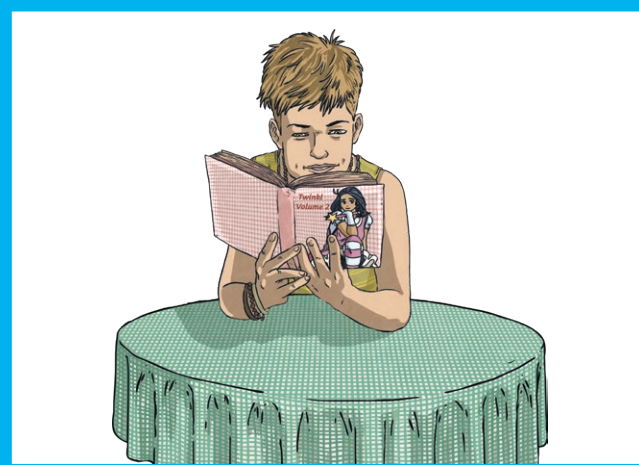
**They are playing
football in the garden.**

twinkl.com



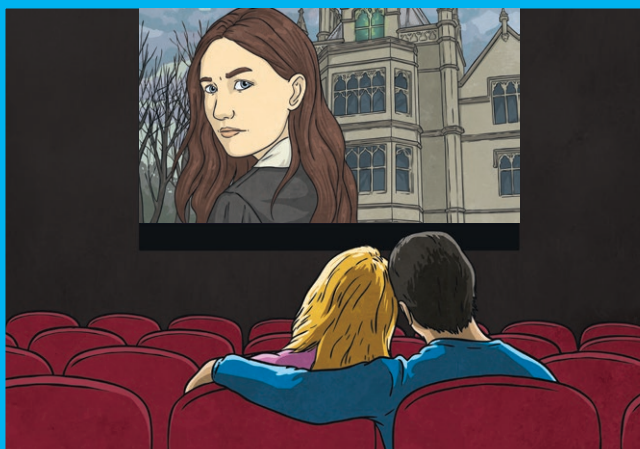
**He never drinks
coffee.**

twinkl.com



**I am reading an
interesting book.**

twinkl.com



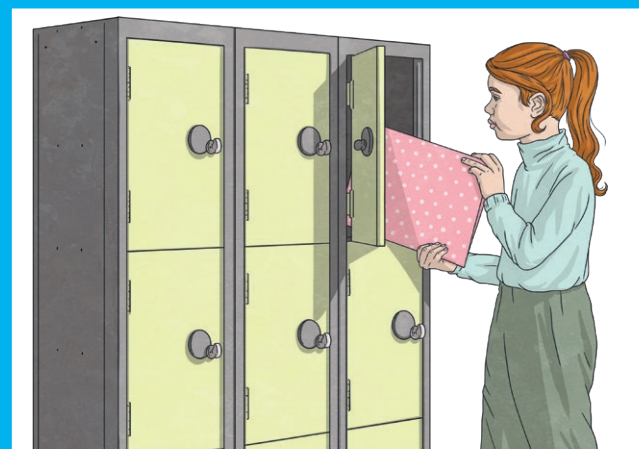
**He doesn't watch
horror movies.**

twinkl.com



**Are you listening to
me?**

twinkl.com



**I go to school every
day.**

twinkl.com



**She is writing
an email.**

twinkl.com



Birds fly in the sky.

twinkl.com



**He isn't working
today.**

twinkl.com



**We walk to school
every morning.**

twinkl.com



**They are dancing to
music.**

twinkl.com



**They watch TV after
homework.**

twinkl.com



**They are playing
a game.**

twinkl.com



**We visit our
grandparents often.**

twinkl.com



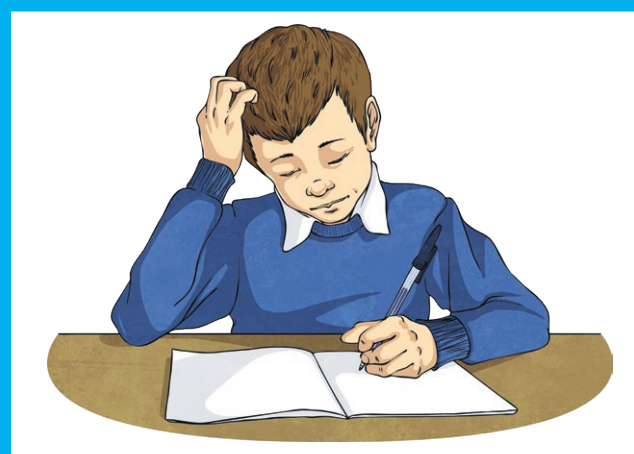
**He is running in the
park.**

twinkl.com



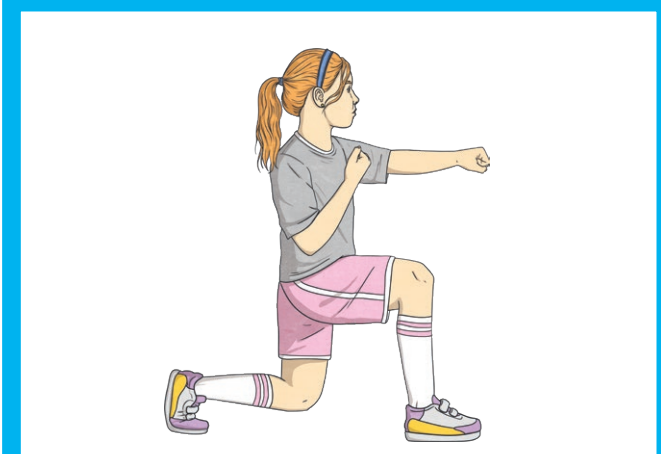
**Do you play football
on Saturdays?**

twinkl.com



**I am doing my
homework now.**

twinkl.com



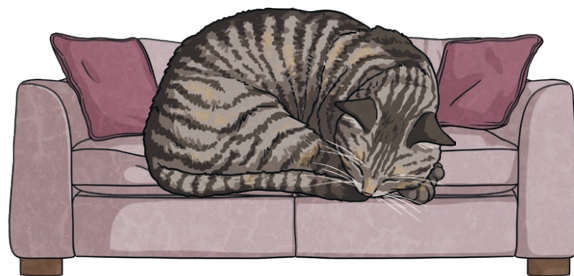
**She likes
to exercise.**

twinkl.com



**Is he talking
on the phone?**

twinkl.com



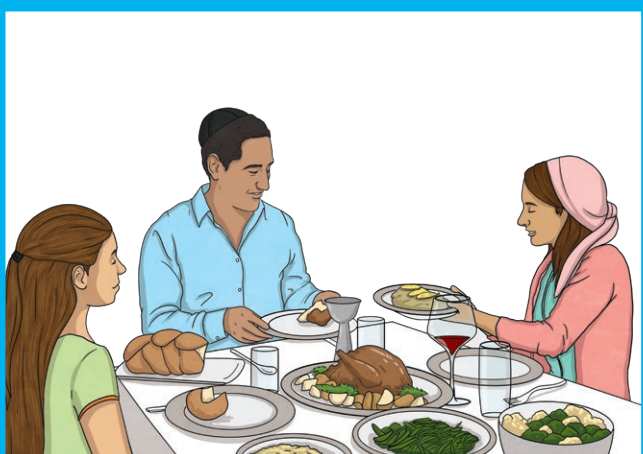
**The cat is sleeping
on the sofa.**

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**She likes chocolate
ice cream.**

twinkl.com



**We usually eat
dinner at 7 p.m.**

twinkl.com

Answers

Present Continuous	Present Simple
My mom is cooking dinner. She is wearing a red dress today. I am not watching TV now. They are at the shopping centre. We are studying English this week. Are they coming to the party? We are learning new words. I am drinking water. He is eating lunch right now. They are playing football in the garden. I am reading an interesting book. Are you listening to me? She is writing an email. He isn't working today. They are dancing to music. They are playing a game. He is running in the park. I am doing my homework now. Is he talking on the phone? The cat is sleeping on the sofa.	She plays piano at the weekend. My dad works in a bank. The sun rises in the east. He reads a book before bed. I don't like bananas. Do they live near the park? Does she speak French? The dog sleeps in the garden. I clean my room every weekend. He never drinks coffee. He doesn't watch horror movies. I go to school every day. Birds fly in the sky. We walk to school every morning. They watch TV after homework. We visit our grandparents often. Do you play football on Saturdays? She likes to exercise. She likes chocolate ice cream. We usually eat dinner at 7 p.m.